Junior Klegseth
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# Text Messages That Came With the Cellphone

1. *Call me when you get this*

   Dear Glum Schwartzkopf vex'd by NJ IQ,

   I hope you find yourself in there. I know you are in there but that doesn't mean I can find you. Are you meant to be found? My therapist suggested I write. He's a mutt we got at the pound, fixed, all his shots, no trans fats, pedigreed and MFA certified. The papers that came with him read, "People can't endure their own littleness unless they can translate it into meaningfulness."

2. *When can we meet*

   I missed the last episode of ♀↔♂ last night. Can you bring it? The part I missed and am anxious to see goes exactly like this (and was, in fact, hilariously tragic):

   *Did you or did you not hit the hermaphrodite?*

   *Yes.*

   *Yes you did?*

   *Yes I did and not.*

   *You did and not?*

   *Absolutely and with total uncertainty.*

   *I hardly see how that's possible.*

   *It most indefinitely is not and always will be impossible, though I'll grant you highly improbable.*

   *I am completely uncertain as to your meaning.*

   *So you are certainly uncertain. True?*

*That is the absolute truth.*

*Read your law books: "The only absolute truth is that there are no absolute truths."*

*Absurd.*

*"That's how it is on this bitch of an earth"*

3. *Where are you*

   Tragic stuff. Everywhere, tragedy. Our dog chased a parakeet into our oven and had sex in disgustingly irreverent positions. The parakeet moaned in Russian and quoted Turgenev. The inside is clean, in case you're wondering. We used Easy-Off. They plan to put it in a memoir entitled *Dog, Parakeets and Other Entropic Explorations*, with the epigraph "either laugh with me, or at me, or in short, do any thing."

4. *Where is the meeting*

   At least barring anything to prove it I'll leap to that assumption. I'll admit to fatigue at times. 11,900,000 results. Even if I could do one a minute it would take us over twenty-two years. Still, I continue my search—I so want the answer. Don't we all? Some kind of resolution. Do we want all of life to be $\pi$? I asked my son to help me. You remember my son? I had two, of course, but we lost one to identity.

5. *Talk to you soon*

   Yesterday Bob told Carol she was being facetious. Tim got upset because after applying an arbitrary absurdity logarithm that strikes out every *t, i, o, u* and substitutes *e* for the first occurrence of *a* in certain words, Willy claimed Susan had in fact called Roger *feces*. Steve's in school now that Ruth graduated, writing stories in the shapes of pyramids and women's periods and spearheads.

6. *I am late and will be there in ---- minutes*

   Sad day for the folks working in the mines of the Metanarrative range. Their attorneys, Lyotard and Sons, say their clients have given up hopes after the company lost "its functors, its great hero, its great dangers, its great voyages, its great goal." A spokesepicene will cry on the news tomorrow and scream, "where, after the Metanarratives, can legitimacy reside?" Some former employees will be offered new jobs, performing lab experiments on fabrications, with mixed results.

7. *What is your number*

   It's an experimental novel I wrote in the air. I left it in the head so next time you take a piss you can read it. Careful with the splatter, though, I don't like my work soiled. I've used every technique available to make it meaningless. A drop of piss could change everything.

8. *I am here*

   Once a hermaphrodite wandered from the house and found itself lost. "There is no future for me, no pronoun, no restroom," it cried. A voice answered, "Surely there is a future, and your hope will not be cut off," but no sooner had that voice assuaged the hermaphrodite's fears than another voice, an orchestral cacophony of static on the air, responded, "The absurd enlightens me on this point: there is no future."

9. *Sorry I missed you*

   No point. Absolutely pointless. Not a point in sight. For two thousand years civilization wandered blind through the streets, uttering lamentations, so defiled with blood that none could touch their garments, none could tell the meaning of the symbols. Then came the age of enlightenment, not to be confused with the Age of Enlightenment. Understand?

10. *Thank you*

The paternity suit ended in a hung story, following this stunning conclusion to the case (and I quote):

*—I fear I must give you an exact account of the road which led to it; ——or to drop my metaphor…——for it will do very well in either place; ——but then if I reserve it for either of those parts of my story, —I ruin the story I'm upon, —and if I tell it here—I anticipate matters, and ruin it there.*

*—What would your worships have me to do in this case?*

*—Tell it, Mr.* Shandy, *by all means.*

*——You are a fool,* Tristram, *if you do.*

A debate continues, of course, as to whether the story was ever told. One thing we know for cert



*Battery low. To find out what this means, press*